

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 697

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the University of Tennessee men's rugby team on winning the 2025 National Collegiate Rugby Division 1-AA National Championship.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body are pleased to specially honor and commend those successful collegiate athletic teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, the University of Tennessee (UT) men's rugby team achieved an extraordinary level of success during the 2025 season, culminating in their second National Collegiate Rugby Division 1-AA National Championship; and

WHEREAS, the men of UT rugby won their first national title in 2021; and

WHEREAS, with two minutes remaining in the 2025 title game, the Vols reached the try zone to provide the winning score, besting Bowling Green 21-15 to claim the team's second national championship; and

WHEREAS, hailed as "true Volunteers on and off the pitch," the UT men's rugby players have long demonstrated their commitment to community service by assisting the Friends of the Great Smoky Mountains National Park with the organization's fundraising activities; and

WHEREAS, national championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the ability to work together as a team and excel with a cooperative spirit; the Vols exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the University of Tennessee men's rugby players epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved the highest level of success on the pitch while showing the highest degree of character in all their endeavors; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a national championship but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the men's rugby players of the University of Tennessee for serving as exemplars of the high quality of Tennessee's college students; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the coaches and players of the University of Tennessee men's rugby team for capturing their second national title by winning the 2025 National Collegiate Rugby Division 1-AA National Championship, thus continuing the Volunteers' proud tradition of success both on and off the field of play.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.